


**Figure 7.4 The Network tab in Chrome's developer tools**

Right clicking a column can configure the view to show and hide additional bits of information. There are two additional columns that are hidden by default, but can be useful when debugging CORS requests. The Remote Address column indicates the server the request is going to, and can be useful for identifying cross-origin requests; the Vary column indicates the value of the Vary header (as you learned in chapter 6, the Vary header indicates which header values should be taken into account when calculating caching resources).

Clicking the request reveals even more detailed information, such as the request and response headers, as shown in figure 7.5. When debugging CORS requests, it's important to pay special attention to any CORS-specific headers, such as the Origin header and any header prefixed with Access-Control.

The Network tab provides more insight into why the request is failing. The HTTP method is `OPTIONS`, which means that the preflight request is failing. Because the preflight request fails, the actual request is never issued. This is verified by the fact that you don't see a second `GET` request to load the blog posts. By inspecting the HTTP headers, you can see that although the request has an `Access-Control-Request-Headers: timezone-offset, sample-source` header, the server responds with `Access-Control-Allow-Headers: Timezone-Offset`, and is missing the Sample-Source header.

Now that we've diagnosed the root cause of this issue, there are a few ways to proceed. If the request header is expected and valid, the server configuration can be updated to allow the request header. But this only works if you have control over the server configuration (as you do in this sample). If you're making requests against a server you don't have control over (for example, if you're querying a third-party API built by a different company), your options are more limited. You can remove the Sample-Source header from the client. That is easy in this particular case, because the Sample-Source header doesn't do anything. But if the request header is important to the request, you may need to reach out to the server owner and ask them to allow your particular header. Table 7.1 explores ways to fix this issue.

The console log message coupled with inspecting and comparing the HTTP request and response headers is usually sufficient to diagnose most CORS issues. But there are times when the developer tools don't tell the whole story. If you issue a simple